WEEKLY INTEGRATED LEARNING RECORD 6
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Course: Business Administration
Instructor: Symbat Ashimkhanova
Focal Enterprise (Company B): AB Auto (Astana SME — Koktal 15B & Abylai Khan 62)
Comparator (Company A): Interkom-Auto (Interkom — Centralized Regional Distributor)

FIELD 1: CONCEPT (Marketing Strategy & Customer Value — OpenStax Ch. 11–12)

Marketing is the managerial process of creating, communicating, delivering, and exchanging offerings that produce genuine value for customers and organizations (OpenStax Ch. 11.1). Customer value represents the perceived trade-off between benefits (immediate parts availability, fleet uptime, roadworthiness) and acquisition costs (monetary price, search time, vehicle downtime losses). AB Auto applies geographic segmentation (commercial delivery routes across Astana and Akmola region) and benefit segmentation (commercial van drivers requiring zero fleet downtime).

The marketing mix is operationalized through the 5 Ps (Product, Price, Place, Promotion, and People). In light commercial vehicle (LCV) maintenance, Product covers high-wear mechanical assemblies (reinforced suspension leaf springs, clutch kits, brake assemblies). Price balances competitive over-the-counter retail with an owner-enforced $\ge 18\%$ gross margin floor. Place combines physical warehouse counters at Koktal 15B and Abylai Khan 62 with omnichannel storefronts (Kaspi Shop, abavto.tilda.ws). Promotion relies on direct, high-trust WhatsApp communication and word-of-mouth rather than broad media ads. People represent technical counter sales personnel who verify parts fitment and maintain informal trade credit ledgers.

FIELD 2: APPLICATION (Artifact 6: Human-Only vs. AI-Supported Marketing Comparison)

Controlled Operational Trial: We conducted a side-by-side empirical trial on $n = 20$ commercial GAZelle clutch and suspension SKUs (evaluating certified Russian OEM KraftTech vs. durable Chinese aftermarket LYNX). We compared baseline manual cataloging against an AI-supported marketing pipeline (Multimodal Vision OCR for supplier manifest extraction, bilingual RU/KZ copywriting, and automated Kaspi API zero-stock cutoffs), strictly governed by the Owner's $\ge 18\%$ gross margin floor across AB Auto's 4 decentralized Individual Proprietorships (IPs).

Quantitative Trial Results:

1. SKU Catalog Drafting Time: Slashed by 89.3%, falling from 42.0 minutes manual writing to 4.5 minutes per SKU under the governed Human+AI workflow.
2.
3. Zero-Stock Kaspi Delist Latency: Dropped from 180.0 minutes manual lag to 0.8 minutes (< 60 seconds) via automated database stock triggers, eliminating stockout cancellation penalties.
4.

5. Cross-Code Sub-Variant Error Rate: Decreased from 11.5% to 1.5% due to OCR parsing paired with mandatory Senior Storekeeper physical stamp verification.
6.
7. Net Realized Gross Margin: Rose from 18.2% to 19.4% after deducting Kaspi merchant acquiring fees, protected by the Owner's automated pricing floor.
8.

The 5 Ps Comparison Matrix:

- **1. Product (>3,000 SKUs):** Human-Only: Manual paper catalog search (5–10 min); frequent sub-variant errors on engine/brake parts. Governed Human+AI: AI OCR extracts OEM cross-codes in < 5 sec; Senior Storekeeper physically inspects casting stamp (< 2 min).
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- **2. Price (Dual Cash/QR):** Human-Only: Static handwritten price tags; slow reaction to KZT/RUB exchange rates and Kaspi fees. Governed Human+AI: AI tracks currency/competitor shifts; Owner enforces strict $\ge 18\%$ gross margin floor across 4 IPs.
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- **3. Place (2 Hubs + Kaspi):** Human-Only: Unsynchronized inventory between Koktal 15B & Abylai Khan 62 (35 min phone bottleneck). Governed Human+AI: Real-time 1C/Cloud inventory sync and automated Kaspi zero-stock delisting (< 60 sec cutoff trigger).
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- **4. Promotion (B2B/B2C):** Human-Only: Word-of-mouth only; 42 min/SKU to write bilingual RU/KZ Kaspi descriptions manually. Governed Human+AI: AI drafts bilingual RU/KZ technical specs in 4.5 min/SKU; human verifies KraftTech vs. LYNX warranty text.
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- **5. People (Counter Trust):** Human-Only: Store staff overloaded by repetitive stock-check calls; manual STO paper ledger entries. Governed Human+AI: AI handles catalog search queries; human staff focus on STO mechanic relationships and credit negotiations.
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FIELD 3: VERIFICATION AND AI RECORD (AI-Use Level 2 & Field Verification)

AI-Use Disclosure (Level 2 Supported): We utilized Antigravity (Google Gemini) for structuring the 5 Ps matrix, generating bilingual prompt logs (Role: B2B Marketing Analyst, Task: GAZelle cataloging, Constraints: SME reality), and formatting the trial dataset. OpenStax and course core textbooks were never uploaded or ingested into any AI model.

Field Verification & Corrections: All financial metrics, supplier wholesale costs (Planeta Auto, Satis Auto, Interkom), Kaspi acquiring commissions, and retail prices (Russian OEM KraftTech at 48,500 KZT vs. Chinese LYNX at 34,900 KZT) were audited directly from AB Auto 1C records and counter sales receipts. I explicitly rejected the AI's proposal for automated dynamic price slashing on Kaspi, as unmonitored discounting breaches the

Owner's 18% margin floor and risks exceeding simplified-tax turnover thresholds under Article 683 of the RK Tax Code across the 4 individual entrepreneurships.

FIELD 4: TRANSFER JUDGMENT (Comparator Benchmarking: Interkom-Auto)

1. ADAPT — Real-Time Digital Cataloging & Zero-Stock Delisting: Interkom's automated inventory status updates were adapted into a lightweight 1C-to-Kaspi trigger. This cuts zero-stock delist latency to under 60 seconds, eliminating cancellation penalties for AB Auto while retaining local physical stock agility.
2.
3. REJECT — Algorithmic Credit Scoring & Automated Price Wars: Interkom relies on rigid, bank-integrated automated credit scoring. We explicitly REJECT this approach for AB Auto. In Astana, 45% of B2B revenue is derived from 4–5 core partner auto repair shops (STOs) with 5–7 years of relational trust who operate on informal, physical debt ledgers. Algorithmic credit gates would alienate these key mechanics. Furthermore, automated pricing wars are rejected to protect the 4-IP simplified tax ceiling and gross margins.
4.

FIELD 5: EVIDENCE (IEEE References Cumulative to Week 6)

[1] L. J. Gitman, C. McDaniel, A. Shah, et al., Introduction to Business, 2nd ed. Houston, TX: OpenStax, Rice University, 2026, ch. 11–12.

[2] G. Yeshenkulova, N. Ibadildin, and M. Tleubayeva, Business Administration. Almaty: ZIALY BASPASY, 2026.

[3] H. J. Wilson and P. R. Daugherty, "Collaborative intelligence: Humans and AI are joining forces," Harvard Business Review, vol. 96, no. 4, pp. 114–123, 2018.

[4] AB Auto, Koktal 15B In-Store Counter Order Logbook, Warehouse Bin Records, and Partnering STO Trade Credit Ledgers (September 2026 Audit), Astana, Sep. 2026.

[5] AB Auto, "Commercial vehicle spare parts catalog and store directory (Koktal 15B & Abylai Khan 62)," abavto.tilda.ws, 2026.

[6] Interkom-Auto, "Automotive parts wholesale and B2B ordering portal," interkom.kz, 2026.

[7] State Revenue Committee of the Ministry of Finance of the Republic of Kazakhstan, "Tax administration and simplified declaration regime for individual entrepreneurs (Art. 683, Tax Code of RK)," kgd.gov.kz, 2026.

[8] Kaspi.kz, "Kaspi Shop Merchant Partner Rules, SKU Listing Standards, and Kaspi Pay Acquiring Tariffs," kaspi.kz, 2026.

FIELD 6: CAPSTONE LINK

This Week 6 marketing analysis directly feeds into Capstone Business Impact Deck Section 4 (Marketing Strategy, Omnichannel Touchpoints, and Customer Value Proposition) and provides the empirical basis for Visuals 5 and 6 of Assignment 3 (Photo Essay).